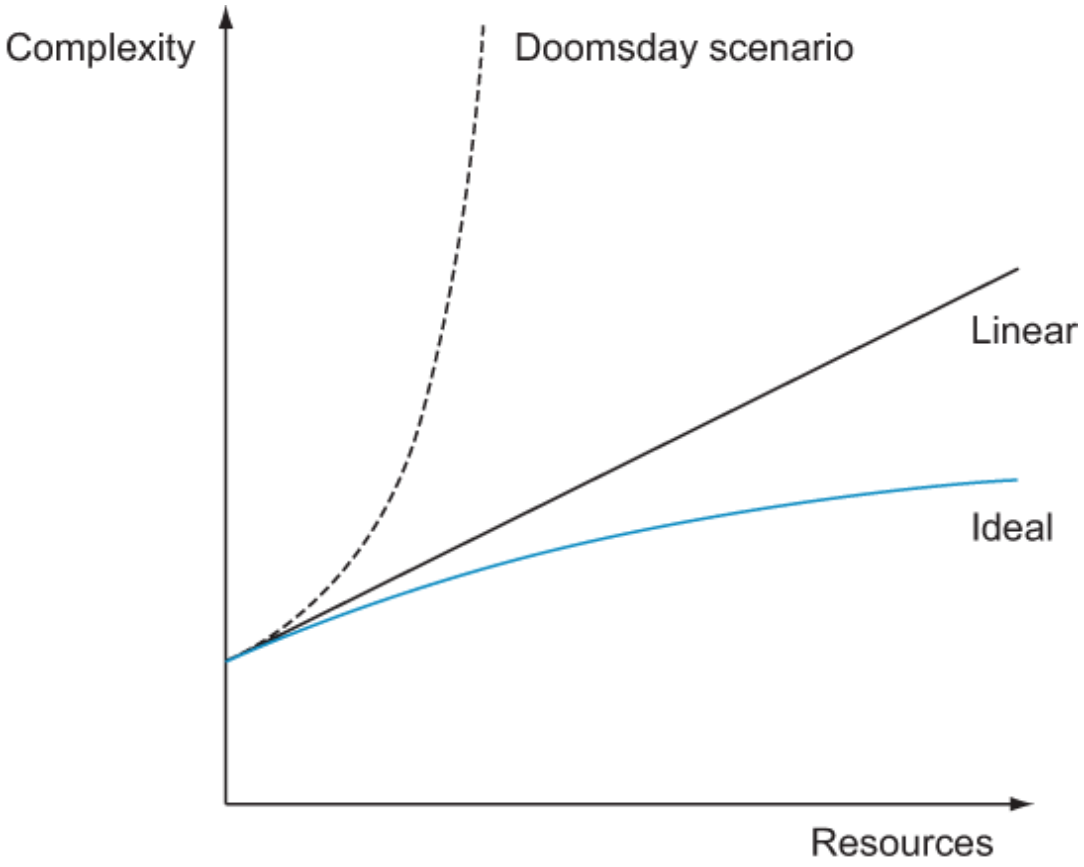

Figure 1.2 Complexity vs. resources

Both the number of required resources and the complexity of the application contribute to the cost of scaling. I'm leaving many factors out of this back-of-the-envelope calculation, but it's easy to see that both rates have a significant effect on the total.

In one doomsday scenario, you have to pay increasingly more for underutilized resources. In another, the complexity of the application shoots through the roof when more resources are added. This leads to two goals: complexity stays as low as possible, and resources must be used efficiently while you scale the application.

Can you use today's common tools (threads or fibers and RPC) to satisfy these two goals? Scaling out with RPC and scaling up with